

Parallel and distributed Computing

Lecture 31

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Lecture 31

A Decentralized Algorithm

Characteristics of Decentralized Algo

- no machine has complete information about the system state.
- Machine make decision based only on local information
- Failure of one machine does not ruin the algorithm
- There is no implicit assumption that a global clock exists

- Based on the distributed hash table DHT system structure previously introduced
 - Peer-to-peer
 - object names are hashed to find the successor node that will store them
- Here, we assume that n replicas of each object are stored

- Every replica has a coordinator that controls access to it (the coordinator is the node that stores it)
- For a process to use the resource it must receive permission from $m > n/2$ coordinators
- This guarantees exclusive access as long as a coordinator only grants access to one process at a time

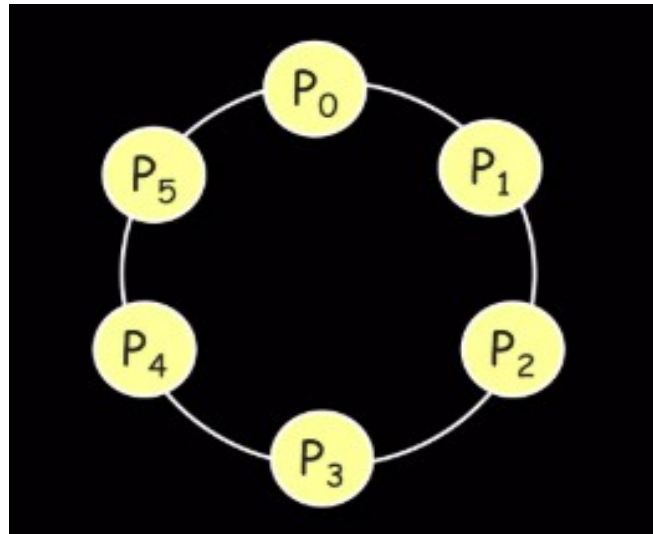
- The coordinator notifies the requester when it has been denied access as well as when it is granted.
 - Requester must "count the votes", and decide whether or not overall permission has been granted or denied
- If a process (requester) gets fewer than m votes it will wait for a random time and then ask again

Lecture 32

A Token Ring Algorithm

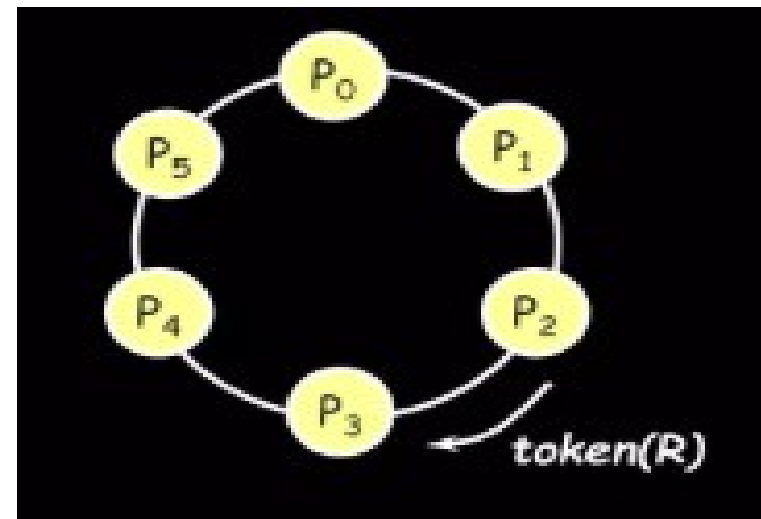
Token Ring algorithm

- Assume known group of processes
 - Some ordering can be imposed on group
 - Construct logical ring in software
 - Process communicates with neighbor



Token Ring algorithm

- Initialization
 - Process 0 gets token for resource R
- Token circulates around ring
 - From P_i to $P_{(i+1) \bmod N}$
- When process acquires token
 - Checks to see if it needs to enter critical section
 - If no, send token to neighbor
 - If yes, access resource
 - Hold token until done

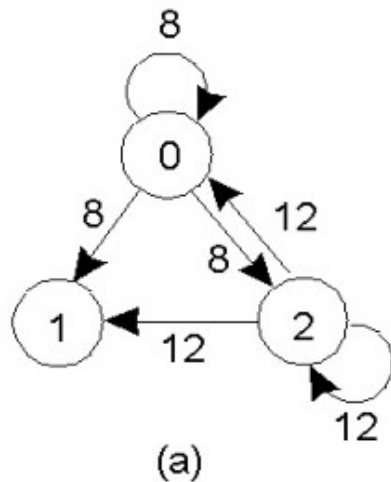


Token Ring algorithm

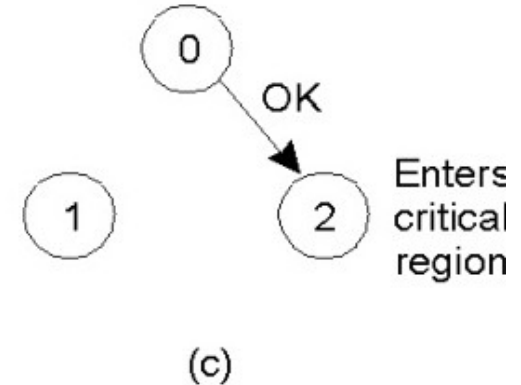
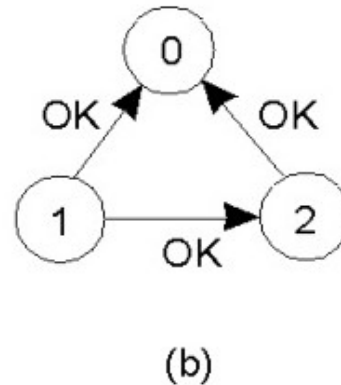
- Only one process at a time has token
 - Mutual exclusion guaranteed
- Order well-defined
 - Starvation cannot occur
- If token is lost (e.g. process died)
 - It will have to be regenerated
- Does not guarantee FIFO order

Lecture 33

A Distributed Algorithm



Enters
critical
region



- Two processes want to enter the same critical region at the same moment.
- Process 0 has the lowest timestamp, so it wins.
- When process 0 is done, it sends an OK also, so 2 can now enter the critical region.

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Comparison of these for Algorithm

Read it by yourself

Mutual Exclusion Algorithms Comparison

Criteria	Centralized	Distributed	Decentralized	Token Ring
Control Mechanism	Single coordinator (central server)	All nodes communicate to reach consensus	Multiple coordinators	Logical ring passes a token
Request Message Complexity	$O(1)$ (request to coordinator)	$O(n)$ (each node sends to all others)	$O(1)$ to $O(n)$, depending on load balancing	$O(1)$ (only token passing)
Synchronization Delay	Low	Medium to high	Medium	Low to medium
Bottleneck	Yes (coordinator)	No	No	No
Single Point of Failure	Yes	No	Reduced (due to redundancy)	Yes (token loss or node failure)
Fairness	Depends on queueing at coordinator	Generally fair (logical timestamps)	Can be unfair depending on design	Fair (token rotates through all nodes)
Fault Tolerance	Low (if coordinator crashes)	Higher (can tolerate failures)	Medium to high (redundancy needed)	Medium (token regeneration required)
Message Overhead	2 messages per CS entry	$2(n-1)$ messages per CS entry	Variable (depends on architecture)	1 message per CS entry (token pass)